P[a]ra[pra]xis: Poetry in Motion

Josh Dubrau, Mark Havryliv
Faculty of Arts & Social Sciences
University of New South Wales,
Sonic Arts Research Research Network
University of Wollongong
Australia
jdubrau@uow.edu.au
mhavryliv@gmail.com

Abstract

P[a]ra[pra]xis is an ongoing collaborative project incorporating a two-piece software package which explores human relations to language and linguistics through dynamic text and sound production. Incorporating the linguistic theories of Ferdinand de Saussure, and the psychoanalytical work of Sigmund Freud on parapraxes, or "Freudian slips", our software utilises player response to automatically-generated changes in a narrative of their own writing to create music.

"P[a]ra[pra]xis Collection Editor" is a Java application which manages the relationships between words and a series of possible substitutions based on manipulation of linguistic slips and "free association". Another Java application, "Realtime P[a]ra[pra]xis", handles the real-time implementation of the above lingual substitutions according to a configurable rule-set.

A rule-set is a set of Boolean values characterised by the relationships between the original word and the substituted word; harmonically and rhythmically, music is controlled by bit-patterns derived from an individual rule, changing as rules are progressively applied during a performance.

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